leaders agreed to work towards improving economic relations and boosting mutual trust.[36] At the same time, the meeting was also noted to illustrate a growing disconnect between India and China.[37] Nonetheless, increased bilateral diplomacy with China appears to be a conscious prioritisation by Modi. Whereas Manmohan Singh in his ten-year period as India's Prime Minister, 2004–2014, visited China four times,[38] Modi has, in half the number of years, already visited China five times.[39]

Enduring disagreement on the disputed border

Diplomatic efforts and statecraft on both sides thus contributed to lowering tensions between India and China over Doklam. Nevertheless, the tense situation and recent military face-off in the Himalayas is a reminder of the lasting India–China border dispute, and it serves as an example of how India and the Modi government have been willing to take a conflictive and assertive stance towards China. The border dispute between India and China has three dimensions. First, at the core is the unresolved territorial dispute over the areas Aksai Chin and Arunachal Pradesh, which from time to time threatens border stability, as reflected in the Depsang, Chumar (2013–14), and Doklam (2017) incidents. The second dimension is the concern over the position of the Dalai Lama and the Tibetan diaspora in India, an issue that dates back to China–India relations in the 1940s and 1950s.[40] Third, India is concerned that China will use its close relationship with Pakistan and the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor to influence the India–Pakistan border dispute. In what follows, I explore the Modi